are many others, but I am too far away to follow the political choices of a much younger generation. It does not seem that there is any significant voice on the right.

It's not that I read much of the poems and novels of the deceased, as I have difficulties in reading Hebrew quickly and get impatient after a while. But years ago, I read Amos Oz's autobiography and some of his political writings, as well as A. B. Yehoshua's novels, Grossman's ones and a few of Etgar Keret's stories, and liked them. It is difficult for people who came with a baggage of very good literature in a language that they consider as their primary one (in my case French) to adopt a totally foreign culture and its literature, sometimes not as good as that of the primary one. I guess that this was an obstacle encountered by many immigrants from Germany in the 1930s and by the Russian immigration in more recent years.

In that sense, the kids born in Israel have a natural way of creating and consuming the new Hebrew culture. For most of them, it is the only one they are aware of until their teens; for many adults who arrived with the early immigration waves, it was partly a culture they already knew and, mainly, a cultural and ideological obligation. Although Hebrew was used throughout the centuries in religious education and in all religious ceremonies and rabbinical scholarship, a Hebrew nonreligious culture existed in the flourishing Jewish community in Spain during the age of Muslim domination, particularly from the tenth through the twelfth centuries, and in Eastern Europe from the "Haskalah" (Jewish Enlightenment), mainly through the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. Some of the literature written in both periods entered the Israeli cannon.

I was quickly made aware of all that and did my best, once I entered the high school in Netanya. I even got a first in writing an essay on *The Travels of Benjamin the Third* by Mendele Mocher Seforim (a pseudonym meaning "Mendele, the itinerant bookseller"), a Yiddish and Hebrew writer in Russia